

Northwind Traders

Enterprise Company Overview & Organizational Structure

1. Executive Mission Statement

At Northwind Traders, our mission is to deliver high-quality, specialty gourmet food items and beverages to retailers, restaurants, and distributors across the globe. We hold ourselves to the highest standards of culinary quality, logistically seamless distribution, and customer satisfaction. By bridging regional specialty food producers with international markets, we aim to preserve traditional artisanal food heritage while maximizing supply chain efficiency.

2. Company History

Founded in 1994, Northwind Traders began as a modest specialty food import firm operating out of Seattle, Washington. Recognizing the growing consumer demand for premium international foods, founders established early partnerships with dairy producers in Scandinavia, confectionery makers in the United Kingdom, and beverage bottlers across Europe.

Over the past three decades, Northwind Traders expanded from a localized Pacific Northwest distributor into a global enterprise. Key corporate milestones include:

- **1994:** Northwind Traders founded in Seattle, WA. Initial focus on Scandinavian specialty imports.
- **1998:** Extended operational reach into Europe, opening regional sales branches in London and Paris.
- **2003:** Modernized operations with relational database enterprise tracking (Northwind DB schema architecture).
- **2010:** Implemented direct automated supplier integration and multi-currency transaction processing.
- **2020:** Expanded North American distribution nodes to support accelerated direct-to-retail order fulfillment.

3. Business Model

Northwind Traders operates primarily on a business-to-business (B2B) wholesale model. We acquire specialty goods directly from international producers and manufacturers (suppliers) and distribute them to small-to-medium grocery stores, specialty food marts, hotels, and dining establishments worldwide.

Primary Revenue Streams:

- **Wholesale Direct Sales:** Recurring bulk orders from long-term retail and commercial clients.
- **Contract Distribution:** Specialized logistics and cold-chain shipping services for third-party specialty producers.
- **Custom Imports:** On-demand sourcing of rare culinary items for high-end hospitality partners.

4. Organizational Structure & Departments

Northwind Traders relies on an integrated departmental structure to maintain efficiency and transparency across global operations:

Department	Primary Function	Executive Head	Key Operational Metrics
Executive Leadership	Corporate strategy, governance, high-level policy making.	Chief Executive Officer	Global ROIC, Corporate EBITDA
Sales & Marketing	Client acquisition, account management, regional sales strategies.	VP of Global Sales	Monthly Quota, Account Retention Rate
Procurement & Sourcing	Supplier relations, contract negotiations, product catalog quality.	Director of Supply Chain	Supplier Lead Time, Unit Cost Variance
Logistics & Warehousing	Inventory storage, order fulfillment, freight management.	Director of Operations	Order Fulfillment Time, On-Time Delivery %
Customer Support	Order inquiries, issue resolution, returns processing.	Customer Relations Manager	First-Contact Resolution, CSAT Score
Finance & Accounting	Invoicing, payroll, credit control, financial reporting.	Chief Financial Officer	DSO, Gross Margin Percentage

5. Key Personnel & Employee Directory

Below is a representative record of key administrative and sales personnel within the enterprise:

Employee ID	Name	Title	Department	Primary Territory
EMP-001	Nancy Davolio	Sales Representative	Sales	Seattle / Pacific NW
EMP-002	Andrew Fuller	Vice President, Sales	Executive / Sales	Global / Corporate
EMP-003	Janet Leverling	Sales Representative	Sales	Tacoma / Washington
EMP-004	Margaret Peacock	Sales Representative	Sales	Redmond / Oregon
EMP-005	Steven Buchanan	Sales Manager	Sales Leadership	United Kingdom / Europe
EMP-006	Michael Suyama	Sales Representative	Sales	London / UK North
EMP-007	Robert King	Sales Representative	Sales	London / UK South
EMP-008	Laura Callahan	Inside Sales Coordinator	Sales Operations	Seattle HQ
EMP-009	Anne Dodsworth	Sales Representative	Sales	European Operations

6. Global Sales Regions

Northwind Traders divides its global business into three primary commercial sales operational areas:

- **North American Division (NAM):** Encompasses Eastern, Western, and Central US territories, alongside Canadian regional accounts. Accounts for ~50% of total annual volume.

- **European Division (EUR):** Covers UK, Scandinavia, Western Europe, and Southern Europe. Focuses heavily on local regional sourcing and cross-border European distribution.
- **Rest of World (ROW):** Encompasses emerging distribution channels across South America, Asia-Pacific, and Australia.

7. End-to-End Distribution Process

To guarantee product freshness and maintain temperature integrity for perishable goods, Northwind follows a strict 5-stage distribution process:

1. **Sourcing & Procurement:** Sourcing agreements are executed with vetted worldwide suppliers. Goods are inspected at origin.
2. **Inbound Freight & Quality Assurance:** Shipments are transported via air or maritime freight to primary regional distribution centers (Hubs in Seattle, London, and Hamburg).
3. **Warehousing & Storage:** Items are indexed into the Northwind ERP database, organized by SKU, category, and storage requirement (e.g., dry ambient vs. refrigerated).
4. **Order Processing & Picking:** Orders placed by client accounts undergo automated inventory checks and credit verification before picking lists are dispatched to warehouse teams.
5. **Outbound Transit & Delivery:** Freight carriers (e.g., Speedy Express, Federal Shipping, United Package) deliver goods directly to client receiving docks with full chain-of-custody documentation.